One tree. One chainsaw. Forty hours.

This is the dome most people never get to build: a 2V timber frame of 120 members split straight from a log — no kit, no metal hubs, no mill. Each member is a wedge, one-eighth of a round log, laid with its rounded face out and its point in, and the gap two of them leave along every seam turns out to be the most useful thing in the building.

Every number in this book was computed by open-source software and can be checked: the cut list, the angles, the price of every part, and the clock. The frame is 37.5 hours of work with error allowed for. The whole standard building is 67 hours, and the book says so on the first page.

Inside: why a split log beats a milled board · the two lengths every member comes in · a pinwheel joint with no hub · one watertight layer and only one · the utility column that brings every service up the middle · and the bill for every part.

Donovan Zeanah served six years in the U.S. Navy as a Mass Communication Specialist, three of them in Japan, and is a certified avionics bench technician now studying on the G.I. Bill. DomeSim, the open-source software this book was computed with, came from one idea: a home should be built like good code — modular, reusable and made to be extended.

github.com/dkzeanah/DomeSimulator

THE 40 HOUR CABIN · Complete Edition · DONOVAN ZEANAH

THE 40 HOUR CABIN

COMPLETE EDITION



by Donovan Zeanah